Which customers should we contact first to stop avoidable churn?

Executive brief for the subscription retention team. Based on a 15-customer sample; read it as a lead to test, not a forecast.

Recommendation. Contact month-to-month customers in their first 12 months as soon as they raise a third support ticket. All 7 month-to-month customers churned; none of the 8 customers on One Year or Two Year contracts did. If outreach keeps 10-30% of customers who would otherwise leave, that protects 41-123 a month (492-1,476 a year).

Decision brief

Audience	The subscription retention team and the head of customer success.
Decision	Approve a 90-day pilot: contact month-to-month customers in their first 12 months once they raise a third ticket.
Supporting metric	7 of 7 High-risk customers churned. They hold 409.93 of 1,269.85 monthly revenue (32.3%).
Uncertainty	Only 15 customers, score weights set on the same data, and an outreach effect of 10-30% that is assumed, not measured.
Next measurement	Churn over the next 90 days for contacted customers against a similar group that is not contacted.

Five findings that affect the decision

Finding	Evidence	What it means
1. Contract type	Month-to-Month: 7 of 7 churned. One Year: 0 of 4. Two Year: 0 of 4.	Customers without a commitment are the ones leaving.
2. Tenure	6 of 7 churned customers left within 12 months; none lasted past 14 months. Average tenure 7.0 months (churned) vs 29.1 (retained).	The first year is where retention is won or lost.
3. Support tickets	Churned customers had at least 3 tickets (average 4.3). Retained customers had at most 2 (average 1.0).	Tickets are an early signal. They may be a symptom, not a cause.
4. Revenue	46.7% of customers churned but 32.3% of monthly revenue is at risk. Churned customers paid 58.56 a month on average vs 107.49. Two Year customers are 47.2% of revenue and none left.	Aim outreach at early, lower-value customers and protect the loyal group.
5. Risk score	A 100-point score from contract, tenure and tickets puts all 7 churned customers in the High tier (60 or more) and no one else.	A usable contact-first ranking, but it fits this sample and is not yet proven on new customers.

Source: customer_churn_sample.csv (15 customers). Revenue is in the dataset's own currency units.

Expected impact

Measure	Low (10%)	High (30%)	Basis
Revenue kept, per month	40.99	122.98	10-30% of 409.93 monthly revenue from the 7 customers who left
Revenue kept, per year	491.92	1,475.75	Monthly figure x 12
Per 100 similar customers, per month (illustrative)	273.29	819.86	Assumes a larger base looks like this 15-customer sample

The 10-30% retention effect is a planning assumption. It was not measured in this data. A pilot with a comparison group should replace it with a measured figure.

Limitations and data checks

Small sample. With 15 customers, one customer moves a segment's rate by several points.

Fitted weights. The score weights were chosen after looking at this data, so the clean split shows fit, not predictive accuracy.

Correlation, not cause. Contract, tenure and tickets line up with churn. The data cannot show that changing one keeps a customer.

Missing information. No usage, billing or competitor data; one snapshot in time. The currency is not stated in the file.

Data checks. No missing values, duplicate IDs, impossible or extreme values. TotalCharges equals monthly charge x tenure on all 15 rows. No rows were dropped. See cleaning_log.md and analysis.py to reproduce.